CONSORTIUM FOR ASIA PACIFIC & EURASIAN STUDIES

CAPES MONTHLY BRIEF

SEPTEMBER 2026 | ISSUE # 16

ADVANCING INDEPENDENT DISCOURSE ON ASIA-PACIFIC & EURASIA



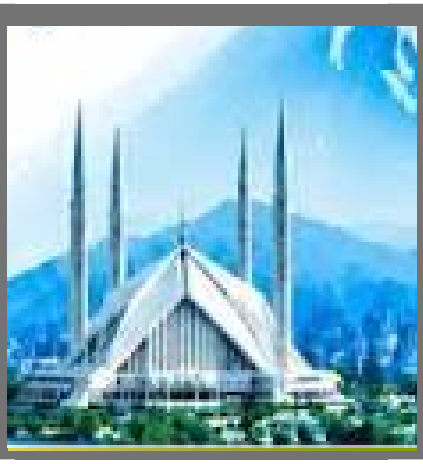
VISIT TO THE EMBASSY OF THE REPUBLIC OF TAJIKISTAN

As part of its 3rd Summer Internship Program, CAPES organised a visit to the Embassy of the Republic of Tajikistan. The delegation was warmly received by H.E. Sharifzoda Yusuf Toir, Ambassador of Tajikistan to Pakistan, who gave a dedicated tour of the Embassy showcasing Tajikistan's rich cultural heritage. The Ambassador also discussed Tajikistan's foreign policy objectives, and highlighted the close ties between the two nations.



3RD SUMMER INTERNSHIP PROGRAM CERTIFICATE DISTRIBUTION CEREMONY

CAPES organised a certificate distribution ceremony for the participants of its 3rd Summer Internship Round. The ceremony recognised the hard work and dedication demonstrated by the interns throughout the program. CAPES congratulates all participants on their achievement and wishes them continued success in their academic and professional journeys.



SOUTH-CENTRAL ASIA CONNECTIVITY FELLOWSHIP

CAPES, in collaboration with the University of Lahore, launched the South-Central Asia Connectivity Fellowship, an eight-week program for students, researchers and policy analysts to explore Pakistan's engagement with the Asia-Pacific and Eurasia regions. The program is open to international higher degree research students affiliated with a university or think tank in the region.

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CAPES is pleased to announce that Muneeb Salman, a Non-Resident Fellow, has secured the Swiss Government Excellence Scholarship to pursue a PhD at the University of Lausanne, Switzerland. We are proud to see our researchers achieve such distinguished academic milestones and wish him continued success in this next chapter of his scholarly journey.



CAPES is pleased to welcome Ms Rida Anwar as a Research Analyst. Her experience and expertise will be a valuable addition to our team, and we look forward to her contributions. Ms Anwar holds an M.Phil. from the National Defence University (NDU), Islamabad, and specialises in China Studies, Environmental Governance, and water and space security.

CAPES PUBLICATIONS

Beyond the Beautification: Is Islamabad Actually Summit-Ready?

CAPES RESEARCH ANALYST RIDA ANWAR WRITES FOR STRATHEIA

https://stratheia.com/beyond-the-beautification-is-islamabad-actually-summit-ready/



"Pakistan is set to host the Shanghai Cooperation Organization (SCO) Council of Heads of State (CHS) summit in September 2027. Hosting a major international summit, among many questions the questions about security and logistical readiness arises. The question is not merely whether Pakistan can provide a secure venue for the visiting leaders. The larger question is whether the capital city can function efficiently under the extraordinary logistical, administrative and security pressures that accompany an event of this scale."

From diplomatic solidarity to practical connectivity

CAPES RESEARCHER YUSRA SARWAR WRITES FOR PAKISTAN TODAY

https://www.pakistantoday.com.pk/2026/09/16/from-diplomatic-solidarity-to-practical-connectivity



"Pakistan and Malaysia have enjoyed strong diplomatic relations throughout history. But this diplomatic solidarity is translating into strong people-to-people connectivity. Despite the regime changes, a tilt towards Pakistan is witnessed in the foreign policy of Malaysia. From taking the side of Pakistan on the Kashmir issue in the United Nations General Assembly in 2019, to forming a joint working group on the recent visit of Malaysian Home Affairs Minister Saifuddin Nasution Ismail to Islamabad in August 2026, the bond can be seen clearly."



Power by the People

CAPES NON-RESIDENT FELLOW MUHAMMAD UMAR, WRITES FOR THE NEWS

https://www.thenews.pk/print/1437566-power-by-the-people

"Sometime in the last three years, without a scheme, a subsidy, a launch ceremony or a minister to cut a ribbon, Pakistanis wired their own country, one roof at a time. By early this year, Pakistan had brought in about 54 gigawatts of solar panels, making it the second-largest buyer of Chinese panels on earth, behind only the port that supplies all of Europe."

CONSORTIUM FOR ASIA PACIFIC & EURASIAN STUDIES

CAPES INTERNSHIP PROGRAM

CAPES INTERNS' PUBLICATIONS

During their internship round, CAPES interns published their opinion articles in a number of reputable national and international publications. These include Foreign Policy in Focus, the South Asia Strategic Research Center (GASAM), the Asian Consortium for Regional Studies, and Strafasia. The interns' contributions examined emerging developments across the Asia-Pacific and Eurasian regions, offering informed perspectives on regional geopolitics, security, and economic cooperation.



Australia–Pakistan Mineral Cooperation: From Potential to Partnership

CAPES INTERN
BAZGHA MURTAZA
WRITES FOR SOUTH ASIA STRATEGIC RESEARCH CENTER

https://gasam.org.tr/australia-pakistan-mineral-cooperation-from-potential-to-partnership/



Mongolia as COP17 Host and Pakistan's Stake in Global Land Diplomacy

CAPES INTERN
FADHILAH AZ ZAHRA
WRITES FOR STRATHEIA

https://stratheia.com/mongolia-as-cop17-host-and-pakistans-stake-in-global-land-diplomacy/



What's Blocking Ukraine from NATO?

CAPES INTERN
LAIBA NASEEM
WRITES FOR FOREIGN POLICY IN FOCUS

https://fpif.org/whats-blocking-ukraine-from-nato/



China's Good-Neighbor Policy: A New Marshall Plan for Southeast Asia?

CAPES INTERN
INZEMAM MERAJ
WRITES FOR STRATHEIA

https://stratheia.com/chinas-good-neighbor-policy-a-new-marshall plan/



The Role of Cultural Diplomacy in Pakistan-China Relations

CAPES INTERN
AIMEN MUSHTAQ
WRITES FOR SOUTH ASIA STRATEGIC RESEARCH CENTER

https://gasam.org.tr/the-role-of-cultural-diplomacy-in-pakistan-china-relations/



Small Island – Global Voice!

CAPES INTERN
FARHANA LAKHIAR
WRITES FOR STRATHEIA

https://stratheia.com/small-island-global-voice/



Japan's Rearmament: Deterrence or a New Arms Race in East Asia

CAPES INTERN
SEHRISH IMTIAZ
WRITES FOR ASIAN CONSORTIUMFOR REGIONAL STUDIES

https://asianconsortium-rs.com/japans-rearmament-deterrence-or-a-new-arms-race-in-east-asia/



Vietnam's Role in the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership (RCEP):

CAPES INTERN
TAQDEES ATTIQ
WRITES FOR STRAFASIA

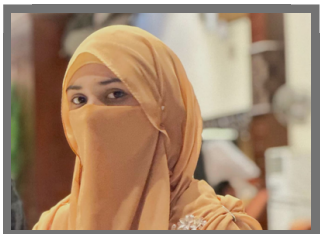
https://strafasia.com/vietnams-role-in-the-regional-comprehensive-economic-partnership-rcep-reshaping--1791346060837



Empowering Women Entrepreneurs

CAPES INTERN
AROOSHA ASIF
WRITES FOR STRATHEIA

https://stratheia.com/empowering-women-entrepreneurs/



BRI and the Changing Geopolitics of Eurasia

CAPES INTERN
AISHA KAINAT
WRITES FOR SOUTH ASIA STRATEGIC RESEARCH CENTER

https://gasam.org.tr/bri-and-the-changing-geopolitics-of-eurasia/



Strengthening Pakistan–Papua New Guinea Relations through Trade and People-to-People Diplomacy

CAPES INTERN
UMAMA ABBASI
WRITES FOR STRAFASIA

https://strafasia.com/strengthening-pakistanpapua-new-guinea-relations-through-trade-and-people-to-peo-1790192934452

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PAK-PACIFIC BRIEF

- Pakistan and Malaysia have agreed to strengthen cooperation in rice exports, Halal certification, and food security.
- Secretary Commerce Jawad Paul met with Malaysia Ministry of Agriculture Secretary to expand bilateral cooperation in the halal agro-food sector.
- Pakistan is considering a special visa-on-arrival arrangement for Chinese tourists entering Gilgit-Baltistan through the Khunjerab Pass.
- The Embassy of Pakistan in Hanoi organized the first-ever familiarization trip for Pakistani tourism stakeholders to Vietnam.
- FM Dar held a telephone conversation with Malaysian FM Mohamad Hasan to expand economic cooperation between the two countries.
- CDF Munir met with Indonesia's Naval Chief Ali to further strengthen cooperation in professional training, defence collaboration and joint exercises.
- Finance Minister Aurangzeb held a meeting with the High Commissioner-designate of New Zealand to Pakistan to discuss bilateral relations and trade.
- Australian High Commissioner Kane met with Lahore Chamber of Commerce and Industry discussed deepening economic cooperation.
- Pakistan has pledged to deepen bilateral ties with Cambodia across critical infrastructure and public service sectors.
- Students and academics from Indonesia and Pakistan came together at Iqra University, Karachi, for the Indonesia–Pakistan Academic Youth Forum 2026.

PAK-EURASIA BRIEF

- Pakistan Railways signed a contract with Russian Railways Logistics to cooperate on international freight and multimodal logistics.
- Pakistan and Kyrgyzstan signed an agreement to raise bilateral trade to $200 million within two years.
- SCO RATS Council met in Islamabad to discuss regional tensions between the US and Iran.
- Lok Virsa hosted a concert celebrating CIS member states' and Pakistan's cultures, attended by representatives from across Eurasian countries.
- Pakistan and Russia launched the ninth edition of their joint military exercise "Druzhba-IX" at Cherat.
- Chairman Senate, Yousaf Raza Gilani, held a meeting with Belarusian President Lukashenko in Minsk, discussing strengthening bilateral cooperation.
- Pakistan attended the SCO Heads of Antimonopoly Authorities meeting in Dushanbe, Tajikistan.
- Pakistan's Ambassador to Russia, Faisal Niaz Tirmizi, outlined prospects for cooperation with Russia's Far East at the Eastern Economic Forum (EEF) 2026.
- D-8 Secretary-General Ambassador Sohail Mahmood held a series of high-level meetings in Moscow with the Eurasian Economic Commission and senior Russian officials.
- Foreign Minister Mohammad Ishaq Dar met Kyrgyz Foreign Minister Jeenbek Kulubaev on the sidelines of the 81st session of the UNGA.